

Northstar employee handbook

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Owner: People Operations

Approved by: Head of People and Finance Controller

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1. Using this handbook

This handbook covers routine work arrangements, expense reimbursement, business travel, planned time off, and company equipment. It applies to Northstar employees. Contractors should refer to their engagement terms and ask their Northstar sponsor before incurring expenses or requesting system access.

People Operations maintains the current version in the employee portal. Managers should link to that version when answering policy questions. Downloaded copies may become outdated; check the effective date before relying on a saved copy. Questions about an individual employment arrangement should go to People Operations rather than a public team channel.

If an employment agreement or applicable law sets a different requirement, People Operations will confirm which requirement applies. A manager cannot waive a legal requirement or approve access outside their authority. This handbook does not specify benefit amounts, insurance deductibles, or compensation bands; those details belong in the relevant plan documents and individual agreements.

2. Working arrangements and communication

Agree on your usual working hours and availability with your manager. Keep your calendar current, including working location and periods when you will be unavailable. Teams supporting customers or production systems must arrange coverage before changing a published schedule.

Use team channels for work that other team members need to see. Record decisions that affect scope, delivery dates, or customer commitments in the relevant project record. A chat discussion is useful context, but the project owner is responsible for keeping the decision and its owner easy to find.

When handing off work, include the current status, the next action, and any deadline. Link to the source material rather than pasting customer information into a broad channel. If a task is blocked, tell the owner early enough for them to adjust the plan.

3. Expense reimbursement

Required approval and documentation

The policy code for reimbursement is EXP-042. Before requesting reimbursement, obtain your manager's written approval and keep an itemized receipt. Submit the expense form within 30 calendar days of the purchase. Include the receipt and written approval. Finance reviews complete requests within five business days.

Written approval must identify the business purpose and the expected amount. Approval may be recorded in the expense system or in an email attached to the request. If the cost changes materially before purchase, ask your manager to confirm the revised amount. Approval of a business expense does not replace IT approval for equipment.

Use one expense entry for each purchase. An itemized receipt must show the supplier, purchase date, items purchased, currency, and total paid. A card statement alone does not explain what was purchased. Do not include full card numbers or unrelated personal transactions in attachments.

Submitting the request

Complete the following fields in the expense form:

- Purchase date and supplier name.
- Business purpose, including the project or customer when relevant.
- Amount and original currency.
- Expense category and cost center.
- Itemized receipt and the manager's written approval.
- Any equipment approval required by IT.

Check the attachments before submitting. Finance may return a request if the business purpose is unclear, the receipt is unreadable, or approval is missing. The five-business-day review period begins when Finance has a complete request; it is a review target, not a promise that funds will reach your bank account within that period.

If you discover an error after submission, contact Finance with the request number. Do not submit the same purchase again. If a supplier refunds an expense that Northstar has already reimbursed, tell Finance so the refund can be recorded correctly.

Missing receipts and late requests

Contact Finance promptly if a receipt is lost or a request cannot be submitted within 30 calendar days. Explain what happened and provide any available purchase record. Finance will confirm whether an exception can be reviewed and what supporting information is needed. Missing documentation or late submission does not create automatic eligibility for reimbursement.

Personal purchases, alcohol, and equipment purchased without required IT approval are not reimbursable under this handbook. Do not split a purchase across entries to avoid an approval requirement.

4. Business travel

Book travel only after your manager approves the trip in writing. The approval should include the purpose, dates, destination, and estimated cost. Ask your manager to confirm coverage for any customer meetings or operational responsibilities that will be affected by travel.

Use the company travel process to arrange transport and lodging. Compare reasonable options for the required itinerary and retain booking confirmations. If a meeting is cancelled, cancel refundable reservations promptly and record any credit or cancellation charge in the expense request. Personal extensions of a trip require separate arrangements; charge personal costs separately from company costs.

Meals and travel records

The daily meal allowance for business travel is \$60. Alcohol is not reimbursable. Retain itemized receipts and submit travel expenses through EXP-042. The allowance is the daily reimbursement limit for eligible meals, not an automatic cash payment when no meal expense was incurred.

For a shared meal, identify the attendees and business purpose, and submit the receipt once. Do not have each attendee claim the full bill. Separate alcohol and personal items from the amount requested. Ask Finance before submitting an unusual travel expense rather than assuming it is covered.

Keep the itinerary accessible during the trip. Let your manager know about changes that affect your availability. If an emergency requires a change of route or accommodation, prioritize immediate safety, notify your manager as soon as practical, and retain the records needed for Finance to review the cost.

5. Time off and team coverage

Request planned time off at least two weeks in advance through the time-off form. Your manager must approve the request before you book personal travel. A calendar entry or a message to a colleague does not replace approval in the time-off process.

Include the dates requested and any work that will need coverage. Before approved leave begins, update the team calendar, assign urgent tasks to an agreed owner, and leave a short handoff note for active projects. Set an out-of-office message if external contacts are likely to reach you.

If two people request overlapping leave that would leave a required function uncovered, the manager will discuss coverage with the employees before confirming the requests. Do not assume a pending request has been approved because nobody has replied.

Unexpected illness or an urgent personal situation may make advance notice impossible. Notify your manager as soon as you reasonably can and follow the absence process provided by People Operations. Do not post medical details in a team channel. Questions about leave eligibility, balances, or protected leave should be handled privately with People Operations.

6. Equipment and software

Contact IT before purchasing a laptop or other work equipment. IT supplies approved equipment. Personal purchases without IT approval are not reimbursable. Manager approval of the budget alone is insufficient when IT approval is also required.

IT records the assigned device and any accessories in the equipment register. Keep company devices protected with the required screen lock, encryption, and security updates. Do not disable management software or install tools that require unapproved access to company or customer information.

Report a lost device or security key to IT immediately. Include the device type, when it was last in your possession, and whether company data may be accessible. Do not wait to complete a search before reporting a possible loss. IT will provide instructions for replacement and account protection.

Remote employees may request a one-time home-office allowance of up to \$250 under ONB-101. Eligible items are a keyboard, mouse, monitor, and desk lamp. Desks, chairs, and internet bills are not covered. Obtain written manager approval before purchase, keep itemized receipts, and submit within 30 calendar days. Contact IT before purchasing any equipment that needs compatibility or security approval.

7. Information handling

Use approved company systems for work records. Give access only to people who need it for their role. Before sharing a document outside Northstar, check the recipient, access permissions, and whether the content includes customer or employee information.

Do not put passwords, authentication codes, payment-card details, or API secrets into chat messages, support tickets, or expense attachments. Report accidental disclosure to IT immediately and avoid reposting the exposed information while explaining the issue.

Customer-data access requires completed security training and manager approval. Request the minimum access needed for the task. If your role changes, ask your manager and IT to review permissions rather than keeping access from a previous assignment.

8. Role changes and departure

Managers are responsible for arranging a handoff when an employee changes teams or leaves Northstar. The handoff should identify ongoing work, deadlines, document owners, and any customer commitments. Transfer work records through approved systems; do not send company documents to a personal email account.

IT coordinates equipment return and access changes. Follow the return instructions and keep the shipping confirmation when equipment is sent by courier. Ask Finance about any outstanding expense requests before your final working day where practical. Departing employees remain responsible for protecting confidential information.

9. Where to ask for help

Topic	Contact	Include
Onboarding, leave, or employment questions	People Operations, employee portal	Relevant dates and the policy or request number; keep sensitive details private.
Expense status or corrections	Finance, expense system	Expense request number and the correction needed.
Equipment, account access, or security concerns	IT, service desk	Device or system affected, time of issue, and business impact.
Work priorities or coverage	Your manager	Deadline, current status, and the decision you need.

10. Revision record

Version	Effective date	Change
2.3	February 1, 2026	Clarified expense completeness checks, equipment approval, and team handoffs.
2.2	January 15, 2026	Added the ONB-101 home-office allowance reference.

People Operations reviews this handbook with Finance and IT at the next scheduled review. Submit a policy question through the employee portal if a procedure is unclear; include the section number so the owner can respond to the specific issue.